



» VOLLEYBALL

PERUGIA LIVING THE

Sicoma Perugia won the Men's Volleyball Club World Championships after a **dominant display** in the finals against Itambe Minas.

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If domination had a synonym at the FIVB Men's Volleyball Club World Championships, it would be Sir Sicoma Perugia.

The club from Italy came into the competition as the defending champion, ready to conquer 'The Indian dream' — a motto written on the back collar of their staff jerseys.

India hosted the 2023 edition of the tournament, wherein the winners of the Prime Volleyball League participated along with clubs from around the world.

The 2023 edition saw Ahmedabad Defenders, the winners of PVL 2023, drawn with eventual finalists Perugia and Brazil's Itambe Minas in Pool A.

The other Pool saw four-time winner Sada Cruzeiro Volei of Brazil and two debutants, Halkbank Spor Kulubu from Turkey and Japan's Suntory Sunbirds.

Defenders, in its campaign opener, put up a tough

fight against Minas but lost in straight sets (22-25, 23-25, 19-25) at the Koramangala Indoor Stadium, Bengaluru.

In its second game against the Italian powerhouse Perugia, the team was awestruck by the Italian side's fiery attack and solid defence.

Perugia beat the Defenders 25-18, 25-19, 25-11, with the Cuban-Ukrainian duo of Jesus Herrera Jaime and Oleh Plotnytskyi causing the most damage.

With this loss, the Defenders became the only team in this edition to not win a single match.

Its captain Muthusamy Appavu, however, was proud of the way his men fought, considering that it was the first time they were facing these